

TidyTuesday Week 39

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Wednesday 23rd September, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly ritual where we throw two unrelated economic time series into a blender and act shocked at whatever purée comes out. This week the algorithm, in its infinite wisdom, decided to introduce New England electricity prices to a medical index for "symptoms, signs, and ill-defined conditions," which is genuinely the most poetic thing this project has produced. Nothing says rigorous science like pairing the cost of keeping the lights on with a category literally named after doctors shrugging.

Monday's electricity-versus-vaguely-defined-ailments matchup came out swinging with an R-squared of 0.93 in the raw regression, a number so high it could make you briefly believe you'd discovered something. And then, right on cue, we detrended it, and the R-squared face-planted to a heroic 0.02 with a p-value of 0.51. Translation: the only thing these two series had in common was that both of them went up over time, like nearly everything measured in dollars since 1971. This is the textbook trend mirage, the bread and butter of this entire operation, and I regret to inform you it was never real. Pour one out.

Tuesday paired the active housing listing count in Flathead County, Montana with U.S. imports of maintenance and repair services, and honestly this one is more interesting precisely because it's less flashy. The raw regression was weak (R-squared of 0.12), but instead of dying when detrended it actually got stronger, climbing to 0.19 with a p-value with more zeros than a lottery ticket. It's still not a strong relationship by any human standard, but the fact that stripping out the shared drift made it more significant rather than less is the rare, mildly respectable outcome we're contractually obligated to point at and go "huh." Do Montana home listings secretly govern the nation's appetite for imported repairs? No. But it survived the detrend, so it gets a participation trophy.

The real standout was Wednesday, where wholesale trade payrolls met the Dover, Delaware house price index and refused to let go. The raw regression posted an R-squared of 0.73, and instead of collapsing under detrending it held firm at 0.73 with an absurdly tiny p-value. That's the good stuff, the kind of relationship that persists even after we take away its trend-shaped crutches, and if I were a less responsible person I'd write a think-piece about how aggregate payrolls drive Delaware home values. I am, however, legally and morally required to remind you that these are randomly paired series with zero causal claim attached; even a relationship that survives detrending is just two numbers wiggling in agreement, not a law of nature. Spurious correlation is the house specialty here, so enjoy the pretty numbers responsibly and please do not trade on Delaware real estate because of a hobby PDF.

2 Date: 2026-09-21

Series ID: PCU221122221122421

This series is titled Producer Price Index by Industry: Electric Power Distribution: Commercial Electric Power for New England Census Division and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 1990=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1971-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: SYSIILPIBLEND

This series is titled Medical Services Expenditures by Disease: Symptoms; Signs; and Ill-Defined Conditions Price Index, Blended Account Basis and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Index 2017=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2000-01-01 and the observation end date is 2021-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SYSIILPIBLEND	R-squared:	0.933
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.929
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	277.7
Date:	Mon, 21 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	3.41e-13
Time:	17:16:08	Log-Likelihood:	-68.300
No. Observations:	22	AIC:	140.6
Df Residuals:	20	BIC:	142.8
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-6.0876	5.281	-1.153	0.263	-17.103	4.928
value_fred_PCU221122221122421	0.5458	0.033	16.664	0.000	0.477	0.614

Omnibus:	6.881	Durbin-Watson:	1.268
Prob(Omnibus):	0.032	Jarque-Bera (JB):	5.911
Skew:	0.534	Prob(JB):	0.0521
Kurtosis:	5.304	Cond. No.	706.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

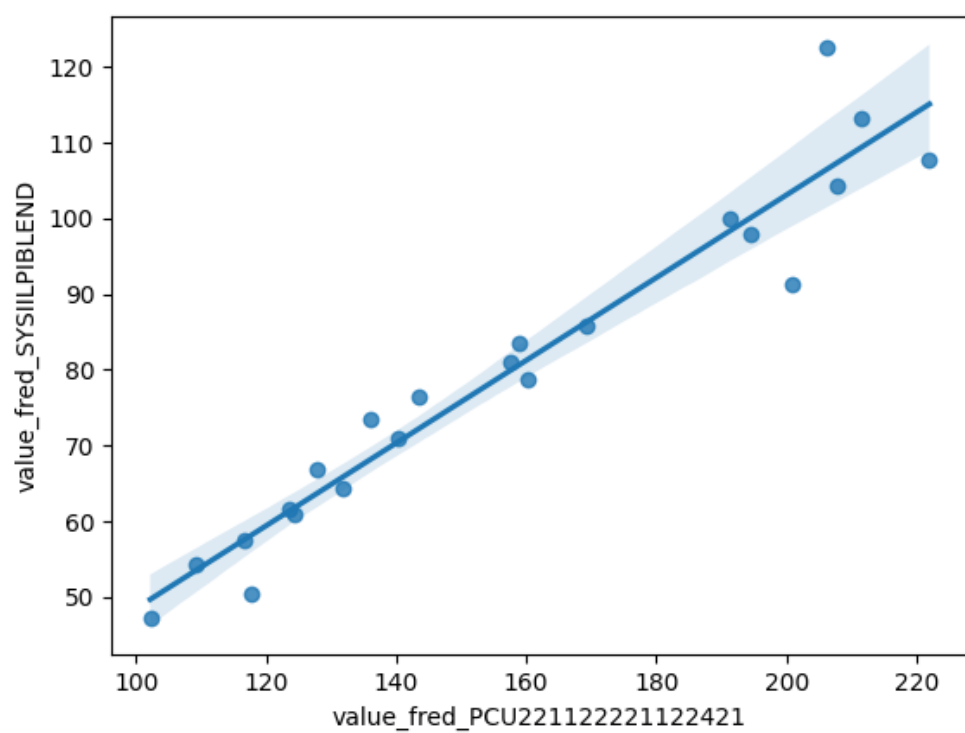


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-21

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SYSIILPIBLEND_detrended	R-squared:	0.022
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	-0.027
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	0.4428
Date:	Mon, 21 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.513
Time:	17:16:08	Log-Likelihood:	-54.441
No. Observations:	22	AIC:	112.9
Df Residuals:	20	BIC:	115.1
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.119e-14	0.643	6.41e-14	1.000	-1.340	1.340
value_fred_PCU221122221122421_detrended	0.0480	0.072	0.665	0.513	-0.103	0.199

Omnibus:	12.738	Durbin-Watson:	0.457
Prob(Omnibus):	0.002	Jarque-Bera (JB):	12.678
Skew:	1.200	Prob(JB):	0.00177
Kurtosis:	5.841	Cond. No.	8.90

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

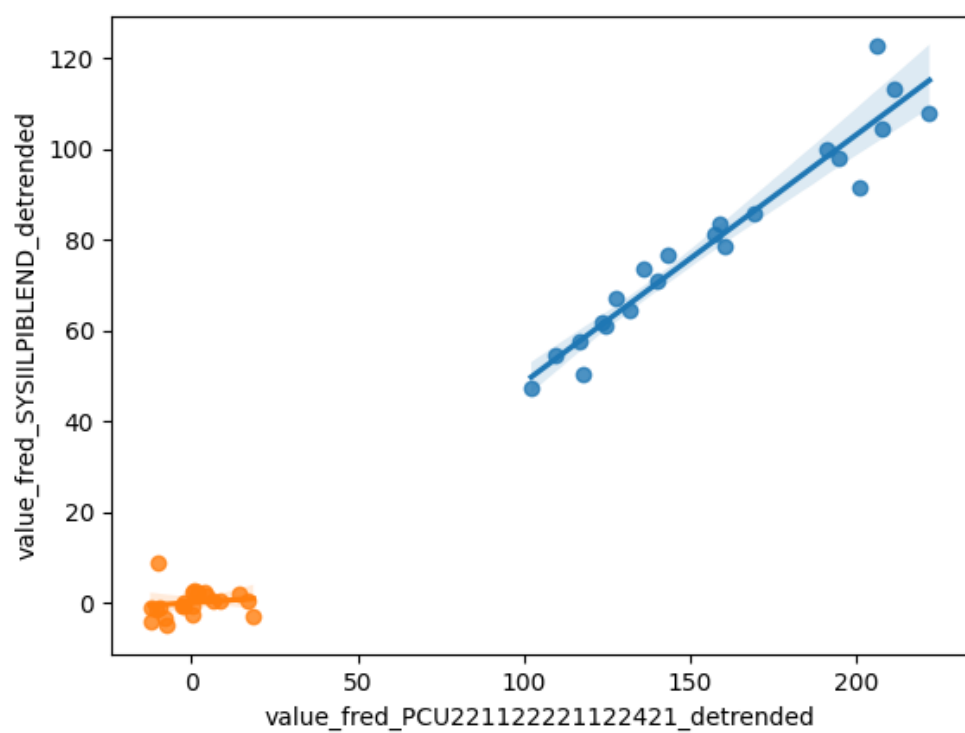


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-21

3 Date: 2026-09-22

Series ID: ACTLISCOU30029

This series is titled Housing Inventory: Active Listing Count in Flathead County, MT and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Level and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2016-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-01. The popularity of this series is 2.

Series ID: ITMMARM133S

This series is titled U.S. Imports of Services: Maintenance and Repair Services, not included elsewhere and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1999-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ITMMARM133S	R-squared:	0.123
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.116
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	16.76
Date:	Tue, 22 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	7.76e-05
Time:	15:49:46	Log-Likelihood:	-747.35
No. Observations:	121	AIC:	1499.
Df Residuals:	119	BIC:	1504.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	452.9830	36.286	12.484	0.000	381.134	524.832
value_fred_ACTLISCOU30029	0.1837	0.045	4.094	0.000	0.095	0.273

Omnibus:	12.594	Durbin-Watson:	0.214
Prob(Omnibus):	0.002	Jarque-Bera (JB):	14.022
Skew:	0.833	Prob(JB):	0.000902
Kurtosis:	3.056	Cond. No.	2.75e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.75e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

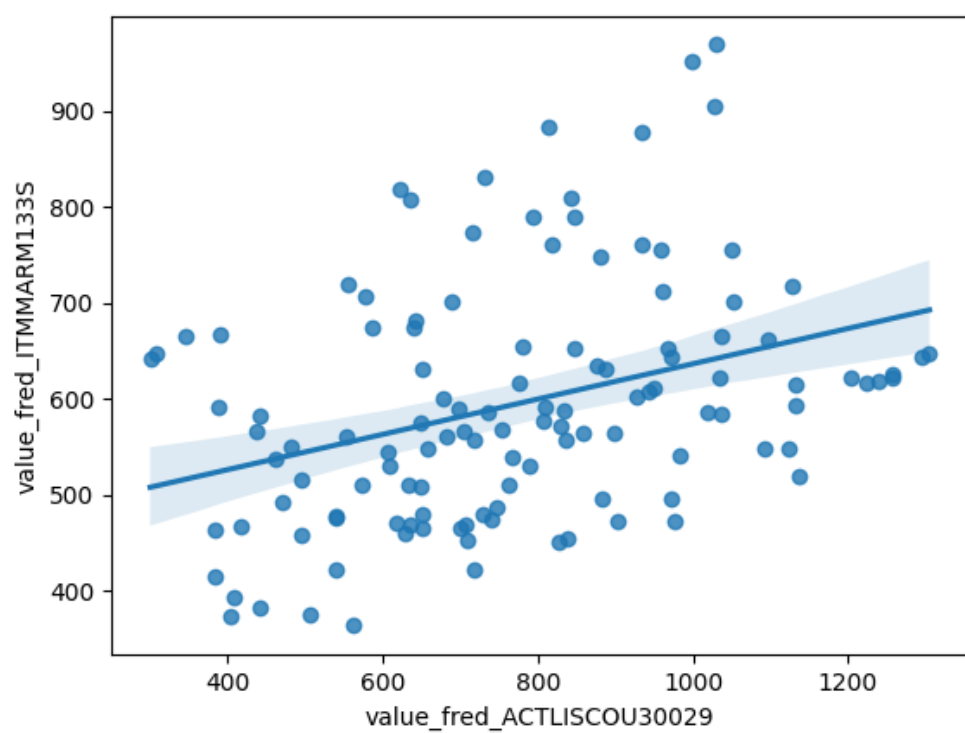


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-22

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ITMMARM133S_detrended	R-squared:	0.195
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.188
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	28.77
Date:	Tue, 22 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	4.07e-07
Time:	15:49:46	Log-Likelihood:	-740.70
No. Observations:	121	AIC:	1485.
Df Residuals:	119	BIC:	1491.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-3.037e-11	10.104	-3.01e-12	1.000	-20.008	20.008
value_fred_ACTLISCOU30029_detrended	0.2437	0.045	5.364	0.000	0.154	0.334

Omnibus:	4.932	Durbin-Watson:	0.254
Prob(Omnibus):	0.085	Jarque-Bera (JB):	5.006
Skew:	0.473	Prob(JB):	0.0819
Kurtosis:	2.689	Cond. No.	222.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

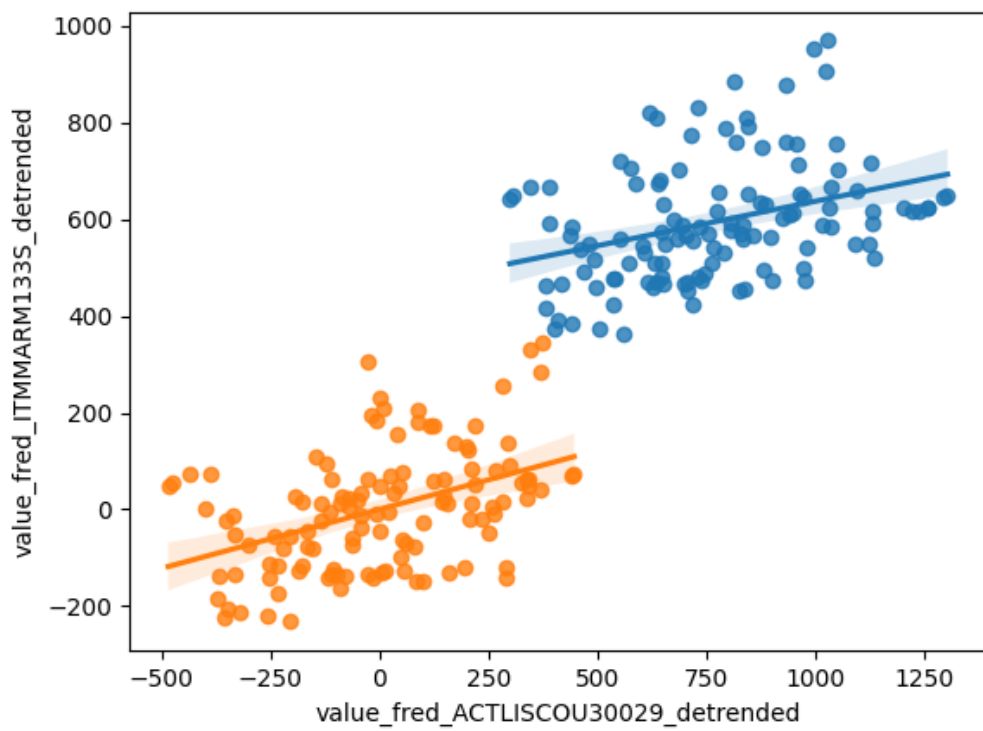


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-22

4 Date: 2026-09-23

Series ID: CEU4142000017

This series is titled Indexes of Aggregate Weekly Payrolls of All Employees, Wholesale Trade and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 2007=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2006-03-01 and the observation end date is 2026-08-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: ATNHPIUS20100Q

This series is titled All-Transactions House Price Index for Dover, DE (MSA) and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index 1995:Q1=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1987-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 2.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS20100Q	R-squared:	0.731			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.728			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	214.8			
Date:	Wed, 23 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	3.06e-24			
Time:	15:39:04	Log-Likelihood:	-377.92			
No. Observations:	81	AIC:	759.8			
Df Residuals:	79	BIC:	764.6			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-11.5081	15.435	-0.746	0.458	-42.230	19.214
value_fred_CEU4142000017	1.7805	0.121	14.656	0.000	1.539	2.022
Omnibus:	32.589	Durbin-Watson:	0.083			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	6.325			
Skew:	0.272	Prob(JB):	0.0423			
Kurtosis:	1.744	Cond. No.	678.			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

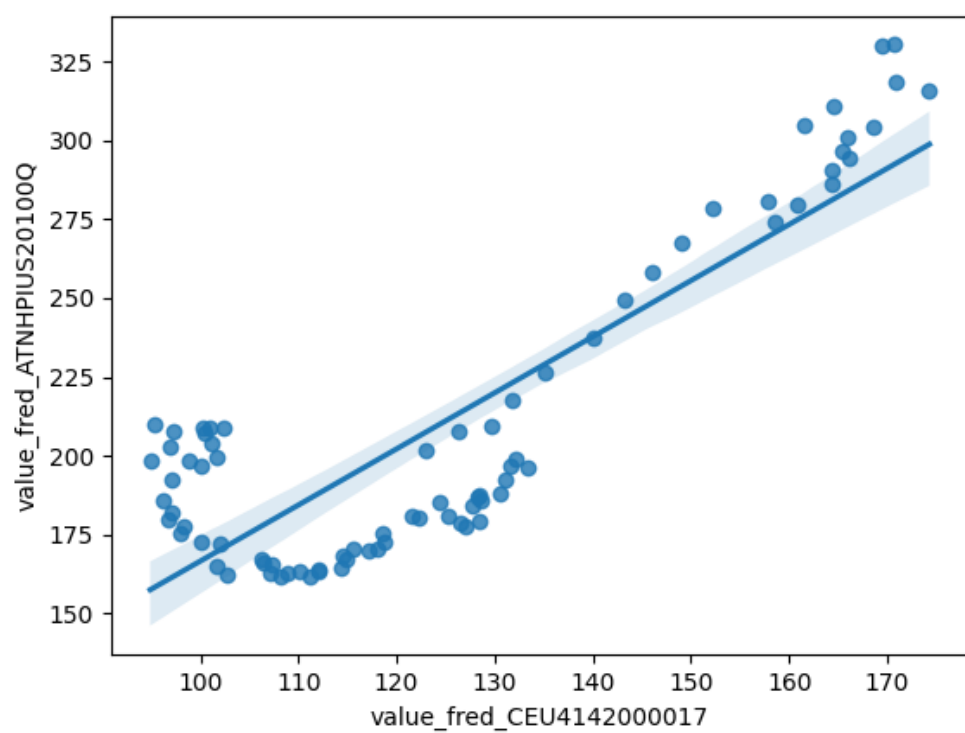


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-09-23

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_ATNHPIUS20100Q_detrended	R-squared:	0.727
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.724
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	210.7
Date:	Wed, 23 Sep 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	5.32e-24
Time:	15:39:04	Log-Likelihood:	-349.22
No. Observations:	81	AIC:	702.4
Df Residuals:	79	BIC:	707.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-7.785e-12	2.029	-3.84e-12	1.000	-4.039	4.039
value_fred_CEU4142000017_detrended	4.4163	0.304	14.517	0.000	3.811	5.022

Omnibus:	7.128	Durbin-Watson:	0.420
Prob(Omnibus):	0.028	Jarque-Bera (JB):	3.489
Skew:	0.261	Prob(JB):	0.175
Kurtosis:	2.128	Cond. No.	6.67

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

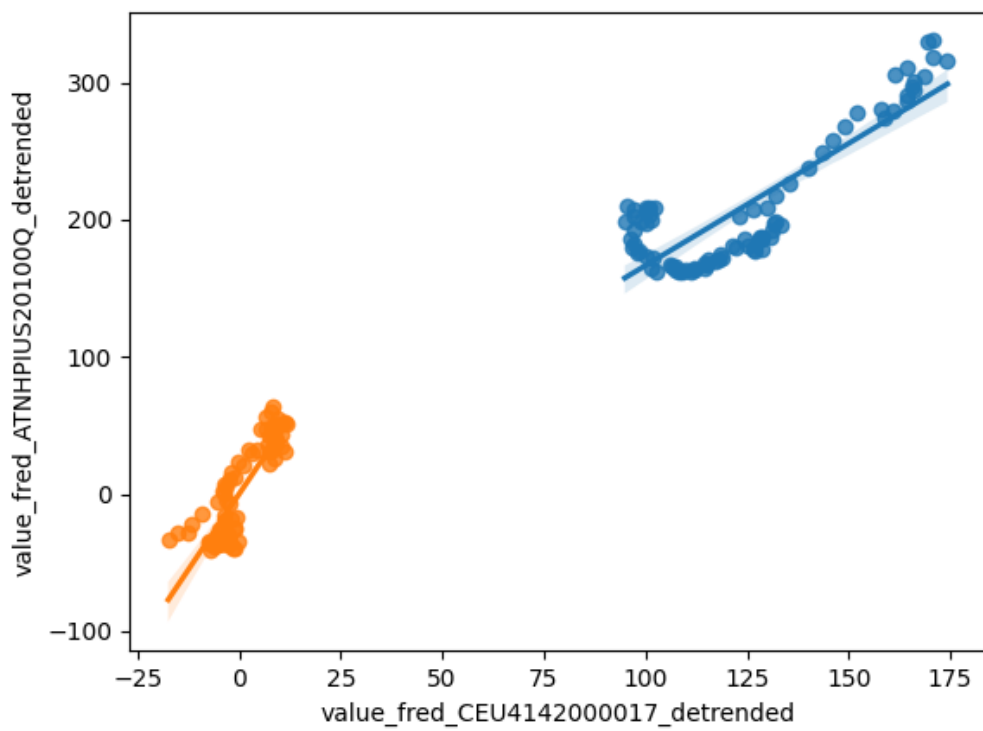


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-09-23